

4.SiSoft Sandra Pro Business 2007

SiSoft Sandra Pro Business 2007 was launched and the File System benchmark module was run. The 32 GB partition we had created was benchmarked using this module. The Sequential Read, Random Read, Sequential Write, Random Write, and Access Time scores were reported at the end of this benchmark, which we noted.

Real World Tests: File Copy

This consisted of copying a 4 GB (1 GB for external drives) file (for sequential data transfer speed) and 4 GB (1 GB for external drives) of assorted files (for random data transfer speed). The time taken for this data transfer was noted. The sequential file transfer time will give you a fair idea about how the hard drive will perform when large files such as movies are transferred. The assorted files consisted of multiple filetypes that included applications, Word documents, Excel files, MP3s, small video clips, etc., thus simulating a real world situation. The tests we carried out were

- a. Time taken to copy the file(s) *to* the first partition of the test drive *from* a non-OS partition of the test rig, giving a measure of the drive's interface performance as well as the write performance.
- b. Time taken to copy the file(s) *from* the first partition of the test drive *to* a non-OS partition of the test rig, giving a measure of the drive's interface performance as well as the read performance.
- c. Time taken to copy the file(s) from the first partition of the test drive to its second partition, giving a measure of the drive's internal mechanics as well as its overall performance.

Real World Tests: Multitasking Copy (External Drives Only)

We copied 1 GB of assorted data *from* the external hard drive and *to* it simultaneously. This tests the drive's multitasking capability, and also gives a measure of its interface performance by taking the USB interface to the limits of data throughput.

Real World Tests: Photoshop CS2 (Internal Drives Only)

We installed Adobe Photoshop CS2 and configured the scratch file to occupy the first partition of the test drive. We then fired up the application and noted the time taken for it to open. We then copied two PSD files, one of them 550 MB and the other 1 GB, to the first partition of the test drive and clocked the times taken to open each of these.

Real World Tests: Far Cry (Internal Drives Only)

We installed the game *Far Cry* on the first partition of the test drive. We started the game and noted the time taken to load the first level completely. We chose this particular game because of a peculiar feature of the "CryENGINE"—*Far Cry*'s game engine, with its rather large level loading times. The peculiarity is that when a level is loaded, the complete map and models are loaded to avoid hiccups during gameplay. It therefore takes a considerable amount of time and serves as a good measure of the hard drive's speed.

Performance

1. The Synthetic Tests

Synthetic tests aim to give you the absolute limit of performance of a drive. They need not reflect real-world performance, and are a measure of the peak performance the drive is capable of delivering.

HD Tach RW

We used the 32 MB test in HD Tach with write-test enabled on each of the drives. Compared to last year, the scores were

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